

UNIT 2 : Empires and colonialism

Definitions

Empire : an aggregation of different nations all molded together under the rule of one power.

Imperialism : formal or informal economic and political domination of one country over the other

Colony : a country or area under the full or partial political control of another country, typically a distant one, and occupied by settlers from that country.

Colonialism : one country physically exerts complete control over another country

Dates

1497-1997 : British Empire, largest of the history

1783-1921 : Second Empire = the HEIGHT of the empire.

1607-1776 : USA = British colony

1803-1890 : the west + Alaska (1897)

1800s : west-african colonization

1496 : 1st exploration → J. Cabot (north Canada)

1607 : first permanent English colony → Jamestown, Virginia

1619 : first African slaves are shipped to the colony

1776 : Declaration of Independence (US)

1783 : acted

1807 : Slave Trade Act → prohibits the slave trade in the British Empire

1857 : the Sepoy mutiny → it dissolved the East India Company (since 1600)

1876 : Victoria = empress of India

1921-1922 : Britain = 400M people, ¼ of the world population, 17% of the world land.

1921 : Independence of Ireland

1947 : Independence of India (Gandhi)

1960 : Independence of Ghana → PM H. Macmillan = speech "wind of change"

1997 : Independence of Hong Kong → end of the Empire

Citations

3 Gs

"Where the sun never sets"

Little Englanders = opponents

Imperialists = proponents

References

- J. Gast, painting "American Progress" 1872

Westward expansion, Manifest Destiny (they are the chosen people)

- R. Kipling, "The White Man's Burden" 1899

- B. Disraeli, "The Maintenance of the Empire", Crystal Speech 1872

Understands the idea of self-government.

Moral and political considerations : moral duty to civilise the savage, Anglo-Saxonism.

Elevate the social conditions of all Britons. WASP.

- **JS Mill, Principles of Political Economy 1891**

Colonies will benefit everybody

Influenced by J. Bentham (utilitarianism)

- RK. Lancaster, "Almost Chattel : The Lives of Indentured Servants at Hampton-Northampton, Baltimore County" 1999

In plantations :

- **indentured servant** (debts) : no salary, limited period, promoted land & money
- slaves
- convict : prisoners who were sentenced

- **A. Thayer Mahan, "The United States Looking Outward" 1890**

Had to open, Gb should be their example

- **FD Lugard, The Rise of our East African Empire 1893**

Humanitarian missions : industrial, medical and instruction (religious or secular).

They impose their lifestyle but don't want those of the Africans.

They had to educate Africa : "*late-born child*"

- **! JA Hobson, Imperialism : A Study 1902**

Opponent to imperialism (the proper Little Englander).

Britain neglected his people :

- **people unemployed, children not educated, agriculture = bad health...**

Empire = too much energy and time.

- **Carl Degler, Out of our past**

"The capitalism came in the first ships"